PunkBackup — Desktop App Usage Manual

> This manual shows the app in **English** — go to **"Settings"** → **"English"** if it isn't already switched. For first-time setup, see the **Installation Manual**; for problems, see the **Troubleshooting Manual**.

Two paths: WiFi and cable

PunkBackup backs up over WiFi with the Shortcut, or by cable with the **Backup by cable** button. Profiles, folders and rules are the same. The background tells you which one you're in: dark for WiFi, light for cable. The app always opens in WiFi mode. See the "Backup by cable" section.

The window has 2 screens

- **"Main"**: turn the backup server on/off, see the address your devices should connect to, and each profile's status.
- **"Settings"**: switch the app's language, and create/manage each person or device (profiles).

Switch between them with the two buttons at the top, right under the app name.

The window opens **maximized** by default every time — resize/un-maximize it as usual if you'd rather have it smaller; that's a normal Windows window control, not something PunkBackup remembers between launches.

"Settings" → Language

At the very top of Settings there are two buttons: **Español** / **English**. Tap one and **the whole app switches language instantly** — buttons, titles, messages, everything — no closing or restarting needed. Your choice is remembered the next time you open the app.

In the top-right corner of that same card, and also in the window's title bar, you'll see which version you have installed (e.g. "PunkBackup v1.7.3") — useful if you're comparing against this manual or reporting an issue.

"Settings" → Preferences

Right below Language, three cards — same on/off switch style as each profile's Active/Paused switch on the "Main" screen. Every change here applies immediately, no restart needed.

- **Start PunkBackup with Windows**: adds (or removes) PunkBackup from Windows' own startup programs, so it opens automatically when you log in — no need to find the Desktop icon every time. **Off by default.**
- **Start backup when opening the app**: as soon as the app finishes opening, it automatically does the same thing as clicking **"Start backup"** yourself — including the same warnings if no profile is configured yet, or none has a destination folder set. Combine this with the switch above for a PC that starts listening for your iPhone completely hands-off after a reboot. **Off by default.**
- **Minutes of inactivity before flagging the backup as stopped**: a number field (1–30 minutes) controlling the idle-backup notice described above under "▼ Show activity". Type a new value and click **"Save"** (or press Enter) — the button only lights up while there's an unsaved, valid change, and briefly shows "Saved" once it's applied, so it's always clear whether your edit actually took effect. **5 minutes by default.**

"Main" screen

"Start backup" / "Stop backup" button

This is the server's main on/off switch — it controls whether the PC is **listening** on the network at all.

- **Off** ("Start backup", green): your PC accepts no connections from any iPhone/iPad. This is the default — the app never turns itself on, even if left open.
- **On** ("Stop backup", red): your PC can now receive photos and videos from any **Active** profile.

Right next to it, the **"Status: ..."** text confirms the mode: `Stopped`, `Starting backup...` (briefly, right after clicking — usually just a couple seconds, occasionally longer if the port needs a moment to free up, e.g. right after antivirus software closes and reopens the app), or `Listening on port 8787`. If starting genuinely fails (the port stays unavailable), you'll get an error window explaining why instead of a false "Listening" status.

Since v1.7.14, the app won't let you turn the server on if there's genuinely no profile that could receive anything — it tells you why with an on-screen warning instead of starting anyway and only failing later, once the iPhone actually tries to connect: - No profile has been created yet. - You have profiles, but none is **Active**. - You have Active profiles, but none has a destination folder selected. - **Since v1.7.15**: you have Active profiles with a destination selected, but none of those folders is valid right now (e.g. the USB it lives on is unplugged). It doesn't have to be a USB — any folder counts, including one on your PC's internal drive; the only thing that matters is whether it's writable right now. Just ONE of your active folders being available is enough for the server to start.

Once the server does start, the activity log shows one line per profile that's actually ready to receive ("Waiting for backup from profile...") — so you can confirm at a glance which ones it's really listening for.

> You don't need to "select" which profile is backing up — as long as the server is on, **any Active profile can upload at any time**, even several at once.

"Server address (same for every profile):"

Two values you'll only need **once**, when setting up each iPhone/iPad's Shortcut (they don't change per profile):

- **Address**: `http://YOUR-PC-NAME.local:8787` — try this first.
- **Fallback IP**: a numeric backup address, in case the one above doesn't resolve from a particular iPhone.

"Profiles connected to this backup:"

One card per profile you've created, showing:

- **Name** of the profile.
- **Total in destination**: how many files are in that profile's folder in total (everything backed up so far, across every run), how much space they take up (e.g. "50364 files, 188.9 GB", since v1.8.8), plus the date of the last backup.
- **Last run**: how many files were saved specifically in the Shortcut's most recent run (new vs. already had) — if that run is still going, it's marked "(in progress: N checked)", where N is how many photos and videos it has checked so far. That number grows even when nothing gets saved, because items already backed up are checked without being sent or leaving a log line.
- **Folder**: where it's saving its files.
- **USB**: if its folder is on a removable drive, that drive's label and free space.
- An **Active / Paused** switch — see below.

The Active / Paused switch

This is different from the big button above. That one turns **the whole PC** on/off; this switch blocks or allows **one specific profile**, without touching the others.

- **Active**: that device can upload normally.
- **Paused**: that specific device can't upload anything (the server replies "profile paused"), while everyone else keeps working. Useful, for example, to cut off a guest's device without deleting its history.

Pausing/reactivating **deletes nothing** — it's fully reversible.

"Last backup (all profiles) / Total files"

A combined summary across every profile — a glance to see whether anything backed up recently, without checking each profile individually.

"▼ Show activity"

Visible by default — collapse it with the same button if you want a cleaner screen. It shows a live, terminal-style (green text) log of each file as it arrives: new, already existed, or conflict. Useful to confirm something is actually happening in real time while you run the Shortcut on your iPhone. It also clearly marks when each run **starts** and **finishes** (with the final summary: new/already had/conflicts/errors), so you can see at a glance where each backup begins and ends in the log history.

Every line is stamped with the **local date and time** it happened (`DD-MM-YYYY HH:MM:SS`), followed by **which profile/device it's about** (e.g. `iPhone de Hesner`, `iPad`, or `-` for a line that isn't about any one profile, like the server starting/stopping) — so with more than one device backing up, you can tell at a glance which line belongs to which one, not just guess from the message text. A log that spans several days (if you leave the app open) still reads clearly either way — you can tell exactly when each backup ran, not just their order.

If a run stays "in progress" without the iPhone talking to the PC for a while (e.g. WiFi dropped, or you closed the Shortcut on the phone mid-backup), the log shows a notice like `■ "[profile]": no activity for 5+ minutes — the backup looks like it stopped` — once per stretch of inactivity, not repeated while it stays idle. How many minutes of inactivity count as "stopped" is configurable — see "Settings" → Preferences below. Since v1.8.7 any request from the iPhone counts, not just a saved file: before, a sweep where everything was already backed up could show this notice while the Shortcut was still working.

Next to that button is a smaller **"Expand"** button, which opens the same log in a separate, larger, resizable window — handy when a long run generates more text than the small embedded panel comfortably shows.

Every line is also saved to a file on disk (`%APPDATA%\PunkBackup\logs\activity.log`), so past activity can still be checked after closing the app — not just what's currently visible on screen. It rotates daily and automatically deletes anything older than about 6 months, so it never grows forever.

"Settings" → Profiles

Below the language switch is where identities are managed — one per person or device.

"+ Add profile"

1. Type a name identifying the device (e.g. `iPhone de María`, `iPad de Diego`) — it doesn't need to be technical, it's just so you recognize it.
2. The app generates a unique **token** for that profile and copies it to your clipboard automatically — you'll paste it into that device's Shortcut (see the iPhone Setup Manual).
3. It then asks you to pick that profile's **destination folder** — any folder, on your internal disk or an external USB drive.

Per-profile buttons

Button	What it does
Choose folder...	Changes where that profile saves its files (e.g. if you switched USB drives). Files already backed up in the previous folder are NOT moved or deleted.

Button	What it does
USB history	Shows the drives/folders that profile has used before — label, serial number, space — so you can recognize which USB is which even if Windows assigns it a different drive letter.
Copy token	Copies the token to your clipboard again (in case you need to reconfigure the Shortcut).
Rename	Changes only the name you see in the app — doesn't affect the token or folder.
Regenerate token	Generates a new token for that profile. That device's Shortcut stops working until you paste the new token in — only use this if you suspect the token leaked.
Delete	Revokes that profile's access (its token stops working). **Does not delete any already-backed-up file.**

Second copy (optional)

Below the buttons, each profile can have a **second copy** — a copy of everything on its main destination, kept on a different folder/USB. Not required, and off by default; it's for anyone who wants their photos on more than one physical drive.

- **"+ Configure second copy (optional)"** — appears when you haven't set one up yet. Tap it, choose a folder (it can't be the same folder as your main destination), and you're done configuring it.
- Once configured, you'll see how many files it has and how much free space is left on it, plus a **"Sync now"** button.
- Tapping **"Sync now"** copies whatever's missing from your main destination to the second copy — newest photos first — and verifies each one after copying, so a bad USB write gets caught and retried automatically instead of silently leaving a broken copy. This never runs on its own; you decide when to sync.
- While it's syncing, that same button turns into **"■ Stop"** — use it if you need to unplug the second drive before a sync finishes. Nothing is lost either way: whatever was already copied and verified stays, and the next sync picks up exactly where it left off.
- **"Remove"** stops syncing to that folder — it does **not** delete any file already copied there.
- If your main drive is ever lost or damaged, this second copy is a real, independent backup: just point your profile's main destination at that folder (using "Choose folder..." above) and the app recognizes exactly what it already has — nothing needs to be re-uploaded from the phone.

Backup by cable

For a first backup or a large volume of photos, the cable is much faster than WiFi. WiFi remains the everyday path.

1. Connect the iPhone with the cable, unlock it and, if it asks, tap **Trust**.
2. On the Main screen, press **Backup by cable**, top right. The app switches to a light background so you always know which mode you're in. This turns the WiFi server off, even mid-copy: what was copied stays saved and the Shortcut picks up the rest next time. If a copy is in progress, the app asks you to confirm.
3. On the profile's card, press **Start backup by cable**. The first time it asks you to confirm that iPhone belongs to that profile, and later warns you if you connect a different one.
4. Check the summary and press **Review and copy**. Keep the iPhone connected and unlocked. You can stop whenever you like and resume later without repeating what was already copied.
5. When it finishes, press **Backup by WiFi** to go back. If the server was on before switching, it comes back on.

Good to know:

- The phone is only read: nothing is deleted or changed.
- The destination and the rules are the same as WiFi. Nothing is overwritten, and what's already backed up under another name isn't stored twice.
- Only one profile copies at a time. A paused profile can still use the cable, since pausing only blocks WiFi.
- **"All backed up" by cable means everything the iPhone shows over USB, not necessarily your whole Photos library.** With iCloud and "Optimize Storage", originals that aren't on the phone can't be copied by cable, and we've also seen a recent video that didn't appear over USB. Always run the Shortcut over WiFi afterward, especially before deleting photos from the phone.
- Every copied file is listed in the activity log, with its name and time.
- The cable and WiFi recognize each other's files by content, even under a different name, so you can use both without creating duplicates. The Shortcut's first pass after a cable backup sends non-camera files (for example, from WhatsApp) once more: the server discards them and doesn't ask for them again. That first pass takes longer and uses more battery, especially with videos.
- Keep the PC plugged in during a long copy.

Typical daily use

1. Open the app from the Desktop icon.
2. Click **"Start backup"**.
3. Run the Shortcut on your iPhone (manually, or automatically if you set up the WiFi automation).
4. Watch it upload on the "Main" screen (expand "Show activity" for live detail).
5. When you're done, you can close the app or leave it — it does nothing on its own unless you clicked "Start backup".

Good practices

- Create one profile per person or device — never share a token between two iPhones.

- If you're going to use a different USB for someone, just use "Choose folder..." on their profile — no need to create a new one.
- Check "USB history" before plugging in a drive you don't use often, to confirm it's the right one.